

BIOMASS ENERGY & AI

Reforestation in Mitsue

Introduction Email — 一般社団法人 more trees



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Introduction Email — 一般社団法人 more trees

Purpose: First-touch introduction to more trees (代表理事: 隈研吾, 事務局長: 水谷伸吉), inviting an informal exchange about their forest-conservation model and possible fit with the Mitsue reforestation programme.

How to approach more trees

more trees is a national forest-conservation NGO (founded 2007 by Ryuichi Sakamoto; Kengo Kuma became 代表理事 in June 2023) running thinning projects at 11 domestic sites and reforestation at 2 sites abroad. Shinkichi Mizutani (水谷伸吉) has run day-to-day operations as 事務局長 since founding — he is the practical point of contact, not Kuma.

How we found you: While researching Kengo Kuma's forest/tree-related work for the Mitsue project's advisory bench, more trees surfaced as the clearest institutional fit — a native-species reforestation and thinning-based forest NGO model that closely parallels what Mitsue is attempting at village scale.

Three rules for the first email:

1. **Japanese first.** A domestic NGO, approached about a Japanese rural forestry project — Japanese-primary is expected.
2. **No partnership or funding ask yet.** First contact requests only a short introductory exchange about their reforestation/thinning model — not site-partner status, not funding, not a Kuma meeting.
3. **Address Mizutani, not Kuma.** He is the operational lead; going straight to Kuma (代表理事, a busy architect) is a common first-touch mistake. Reference his role explicitly to show the email is informed.

How to find the right contact

- Use the **contact form at <https://www.more-trees.org/>** (no public direct staff email found)
- Address the message to 水谷伸吉様 (事務局長) by name in the body even though it's submitted through the general form — this signals it isn't generic mass outreach
- General phone if needed: 03-5770-3969

What to expect

- NGOs of this size typically reply in **1–3 weeks**; do not follow up before two weeks
- A positive reply will likely be a short acknowledgement, possibly forwarding to a program staff member rather than Mizutani directly
- Do not attach full project documentation on first contact — offer the English/Japanese README or introduction A4 only if asked

After the first contact

If they engage, consider — *in this order*:

1. A short call or written exchange about their thinning/reforestation site model and partner criteria
2. Whether Mitsue's reforestation area could align with a future more trees site (森) or receive advisory input on species selection
3. Any introduction to Kuma or the wider network, only once mutual interest is established

Draft Email — 日本語版

To: more trees お問い合わせフォーム (<https://www.more-trees.org/>) — 本文中で水谷伸吉様（事務局長）宛てを明記 **Subject:** 森林再生プロジェクトについてのご相談 — 御杖村プロジェクトより

一般社団法人 more trees 事務局長 水谷伸吉様

突然のご連絡失礼いたします。貴団体の間伐・森林再生の取り組みを拝見し、私どもが奈良県御杖村で進めている森林再生プロジェクトにとって大変参考になる、また将来的にご縁をいただけるかもしれない団体と考え、ご連絡差し上げております。

オランダ出身で、現在奈良県御杖村において小規模AIデータセンターと森林再生・林業再活性化を核とした地域再生プロジェクトを準備しております、Rob Oudendijk（ロブ・アウデンダイク）と申します。

隈研吾氏の樹木・森林関連のお仕事を調べる中で、貴団体が坂本龍一様設立以来取り組まれてきた間伐・広葉樹再生の活動を知り、深く感銘を受けました。私どもが目指す「短期的利益よりも生態系・野生生物の生息環境を優先した広葉樹の再生」という方針と、貴団体の理念に重なる部分が多いと感じております。

御杖村プロジェクトの概要（簡略）：

- ・ 奈良県御杖村における25年スケールの森林再生・林業再活性化プログラム（御杖村森林組合が実行主体）
- ・ 在来広葉樹による再生を軸とし、短期的収益より生態系・野生動物の生息環境を優先
- ・ 間伐材を活用したバイオマスCHP（熱電併給）と固定価格買取制度（FIT）による売電収入を、組合の増員・機材投資の原資とし、林業再活性化と森林再生を自己循環させる仕組み（2基×0.6MWeのガス化発電機を想定）
- ・ 小規模AIデータセンター（旧菅野小学校活用）とバイオマスエネルギーを組み合わせた地域再生モデル
- ・ 御杖村が環境省補助で策定した公式の再エネ導入最大化計画（2025年）の実行を担う位置づけ

つきましては、もし機会がございましたら、貴団体の間伐・森林再生の進め方や、森の選定・パートナー基準について、短時間で構いませんので伺えれば幸いです。まずは知見を学ばせていただければという趣旨のご連絡であり、現時点で何かをお願いするものではございません。

ご多忙のところ恐縮ではございますが、ご一考いただけますと幸いです。何卒よろしくお願い申し上げます。

Rob Oudendijk（ロブ・アウデンダイク） バイオマスエネルギーとAI 創設者 YR-Design 代表 / Safecast コア・コントリビューター Email: oudendijk.biz@gmail.com Project: <https://mitsue.it>

Draft Email — English version (for parallel reference)

To: more trees contact form, addressed to Shinkichi Mizutani (事務局長) by name in the body **Subject:** Inquiry about forest restoration — from the Mitsue Village Project

Dear Mizutani-san (水谷伸吉様), Executive Director of more trees,

I am writing to introduce the Mitsue Village Project. While researching Kengo Kuma's tree- and forest-related work, I came across more trees' thinning and reforestation activities and found them deeply relevant to what we are building in Mitsue.

My name is Rob Oudendijk, a Dutch national currently preparing a rural revitalization project in Mitsue Village (御杖村), Nara Prefecture, centered on forest restoration and forestry revitalization alongside a small-scale AI data center.

Learning that more trees has carried out thinning and native-forest reforestation work since Ryuichi Sakamoto founded the organisation, I was struck by how closely it echoes our own principle: restoring native broadleaf forest for wildlife habitat and ecosystem health, ahead of short-term timber profit.

Project at a glance:

- A 25-year forest restoration and forestry revitalization programme in Mitsue Village, Nara (implemented by the Mitsue Forestry Cooperative, 御杖村森林組合)
- Native broadleaf reforestation prioritizing ecosystem and wildlife habitat over short-term yield
- A biomass CHP (combined heat and power) system fuelled by forest thinnings, selling power under Japan's FIT scheme (feed-in tariff) — revenue that funds cooperative workforce growth and equipment, which in turn expands both forestry and reforestation capacity (planned as 2×0.6 MWe gasifier gensets)
- Paired with a small AI/edge-compute data center in a repurposed former elementary school
- Aligned with Mitsue Village's official MoE-funded Renewable Energy Plan (2025), with the project positioned as its implementation vehicle

If you would be open to it, I would greatly appreciate learning briefly about how more trees selects and manages its forest sites and partnerships. This is a first, learning-oriented inquiry — I am not asking for anything specific at this stage.

I am grateful for any consideration you can give to this request.

With sincere thanks,

Rob Oudendijk Founder, BIOMASS ENERGY & AI project Founder, YR-Design · Core Contributor, Safecast Email: oudendijk.biz@gmail.com Project: <https://mitsue.it>

Notes for sending

- **Send Japanese first.** Paste the Japanese block into the contact form; English below or omitted on first send.
- **Subject line:** 「森林再生プロジェクトについてのご相談」
- **Address Mizutani by name** in the body even though submission goes through the general contact form.
- **Attachments:** None on first contact.
- **Do not mention** the AI data center as the primary focus, funding asks, or requests to meet Kengo Kuma directly. Keep the frame on forest restoration.
- **Follow-up cadence:** If no reply in 14–21 calendar days, one polite follow-up (1–2 sentences) is acceptable. After that, leave it.